

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 4
♥ 6 5 2
♦ K Q J T 5
♣ K 8

♠ A 7 6
♥ Q J 9 4
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 7 5 3



♠ 9 3 2
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J T 2

♠ K Q J 5
♥ K T
♦ A 8 3
♣ A 9 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

You were lucky the ♥A was with East.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need 3 more winners, and they must come from the ♥ suit. The danger is that when you knock out the ♥A, West may take too many ♦s. To exhaust East of ♦s you hold-up your ♦A until the third round.

Next you start on ♥s by playing ♥K, then overtaking the ♥10. Assume that East wins the second ♥.

You were fortunate it was East who took the ♥A, and that he has no ♦ to return. If he plays a ♥ or a ♠ you will win in dummy. If he plays a ♣ you will jump up with the ♣A and take your winners, 9 in all.

But if you had not held-up your ♦A even good luck wouldn't have helped you.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J T 5

♥ J T

♦ 9 6 2

♣ J 7 6

♠ A 7 6

♥ A 8 6 5 3

♦ K 5

♣ A K 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4 3

♥ Q 9 7 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q T 2

♠ 8 2

♥ K 4

♦ Q J T 7 3

♣ 9 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

bank; ♠A, ♦K, ♦Q. You take your ♥K, cash the two good ♦s, then lead to dummy for the ♣AK and ♥A. Voila!

You were lucky that East had the ♦A since he only had 3 ♠s.

But what if East actually held 4 ♠s? No problem, in that case the ♠s would have split 4-4 so the defenders could only win 3 ♠ tricks and the ♦A.

The hold-up lets you make the contract whenever East holds the ♦A. And if West happened to hold the ♦A??? You go down.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 5

Even if ♥s split 3-3 you could only get 2 extra winners there, so it should be clear that you must establish the ♦s. You will have to drive out the ♦A and hope they don't win too many ♠s at that time. You can help your chances by a hold-up of the ♠A until the third round.

Having just taken the third ♠ trick you now work on ♦s by first playing the ♦K, then continuing the suit. East wins the third one with his ♦A. And now the good news - he has no ♠ left to reach his partner's good tricks. So East plays the ♥Q.

At this point in the play you have three tricks in the

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 7 3 2

♥ T 7

♦ 6 5

♣ J T 8 2

♠ T 5

♥ K 8 5 4

♦ A T 9 3

♣ K 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K 7 4

♣ 9 7 3

♠ K 9 4

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ A Q 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

Pass

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

the other suits. You don't care which he leads because you can now win 8 more tricks and make your contract.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East wins the first trick with the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You can win 3 more ♦ tricks if the finesse works, but even if it doesn't work you can still get the 2 that you need. Of course if East does win the ♦K it would sure be great if he had no ♠ to lead. So you duck the second ♠ and take your ♠K when they play a third round.

After winning the ♠K you are conveniently in your hand, so you play the ♦Q and let it ride when West plays a low card. Alas, East takes the trick with his ♦K.

It's too bad the finesse didn't work, but it's not too too bad! Because East is out of ♠s and must lead one of

As long as you were going to finesse into East you could establish the ♦s without allowing West to gain the lead.

And as long as you had held up on the ♠K until the third round you could ensure that East was out of ♠s if he had started with only 3.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 4
♥ 6 5 4 2
♦ K Q J 4
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 6
♥ A T 9
♦ 7 5 2
♣ K J T 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 3 2
♥ Q 8 3
♦ T 9 6
♣ A Q 3

♠ A K 7 5
♥ K J 7
♦ A 8 3
♣ 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Win with dummy's ♠Q and force out the ♣A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If East had only held 2 ♦s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If West has 5 ♦s and also the ♣A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where East has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick. So hold up the ♦A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣s. Play your ♣9 and let it ride. East wins the ♣Q and returns a ♠. Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦.